

Sebastian Zuniga Rivas

UX Engineer / Design Systems & Frontend Specialist

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Summary

Designer by training, builder by instinct. I've been making things for the web since the 90s and spent 10+ years moving fluidly between UI/UX design and frontend development - across large organizations, early-stage startups, and my own indie game studio. I pick up new tools because I'm curious, build them when they don't exist, and know when to let go of something I made in favor of a better solution. Based in Tokyo, driven by curiosity and not afraid of new challenges.

Core Competencies

UX/UI Design, Design Systems & Prototyping, Development, Game Development (Indie), Agile Methodologies, Cross-functional Collaboration, trilingual: English (Professional Working), Spanish (Native) & Japanese(learning).

Design: Sketch, Figma, Rive, Principle.

Front-end Development: HTML5, CSS3, SASS, JavaScript, TypeScript, React.js, SwiftUI, Tailwind.

Methodologies & Collaboration: Agile/Scrum, Design Systems, Storybook, Docker, Git, Notion, Slack, Discord, Jira.

Experience

Personal Project - Tangara Studio | Indie Game Developer / Art Director

09/2023 – Present

Project: Dinopirates

- Designed and developed an original game using Lua, owning art, UI, game mechanics, and performance optimization.
- Built internal level-creation tooling in Swift, then migrated to LDtk when the problem outgrew the custom solution - significantly reducing content production time.
- Designed and implemented UI systems in Unity, creating reusable prefabs for animation and character pipelines.

Storymoon | UX/UI Designer

09/2025 - 11/2025 | Spain

- Owned branding and UI design, conducted user testing, and shaped the first product prototype.
- Contributed directly to frontend development using Tailwind CSS.

Brave UP! | UX/UI/Frontend Developer

03/2022 - 09/2023 | United States

- Implemented standardized SASS modules and D3.js data visualizations
- Maintained and evolved the existing design system
- Created SwiftUI components and interactions to ensure design feasibility
- Supported developers by improving code clarity, consistency, and cross-device compatibility.

Deviants Factions | Frontend Developer

10/2021 - 02/2022 | WorldWide

- Translated desktop UI designs into mobile-first, responsive layouts using CSS3
- Improved mobile usability testing scores by 25%.
- Collaborated remotely across 10+ countries and multiple time zones while maintaining delivery timelines.

Clever By BICE | UI Frontend Developer

11/2020 - 10/2021 | Santiago, Chile

- Facilitated weekly QA sessions between design and development teams, accelerating delivery and improving product quality.
- Proactively supported the mobile team during a period without an iOS developer by building the foundational app structure, despite it being a first professional experience with iOS development.

Elun | Product Designer

02/2019 - 09/2020 | Viña del Mar, Chile

- Stepped into frontend development during high-demand periods, applying design knowledge to bridge the gap and keep delivery on track.

Baufest | UI Designer

11/2017 - 02/2019 | Santiago, Chile

- Managed and promoted a modular design system for banking platforms.
- Reduced handoff issues by 35% and improved UI consistency across two major projects.
- Standardized asset versioning workflows in Abstract, reducing duplicate assets by 20%.

McKinsey & Company | Senior Visual Designer

03/2017 - 10/2017 | Santiago, Chile

- Introduced prototyping tools (Sketch, Principle) to client design teams.
- Reduced design review cycles by 25% and accelerated tool adoption within three months.
- Supported design and development teams across multiple countries in adopting design systems and modern workflows.

Earlier Experience

Brave UP! | Freelance UI Designer

10/2014 - 03/2015 | Chile

DeNA West | UI Artist

05/2014 - 09/2014 | Santiago, Chile

Elun | Web/App Designer |

05/2011 - 09/2014 | Viña del Mar, Chile

- Built strong collaboration with development teams by learning engineering concepts early, reducing design-development handoff time by 60%

Education

Bachelor's in Graphic Design, Universidad de Valparaíso, 2007 - 2013

Dear **Noun team**,

The way this role is framed - thinking through making, reaching for the most effective tool rather than defaulting to a fixed process, using AI as a natural extension of the creative workflow - is genuinely how I work, not a posture I'm pitching toward.

I've spent my career at the intersection of design and code, moving between them based on what the problem needs. I prototype in the browser. I've shipped products at McKinsey and at startups where the team was small and the scope was everything. I co-founded a game studio and build in languages like Lua not because the brief calls for it, but because staying hands-on across unfamiliar tools is how I keep the thinking honest.

A through-line in my work is building tools - for myself and for collaborators. Custom pipelines, internal utilities, things that didn't exist so I made them. But I've also learned when a tool I built has met its limit: I once developed a native Swift solution for a pipeline problem I was trying to solve, spent real time on it, then recognized that an established tool - LDtk - did the job better. I deprecated my own work without hesitation. That kind of judgment - knowing when your solution is the right one and when it isn't - feels directly relevant to what Noun does.

When AI tools like Claude or Cursor help me close the gap between concept and something testable, I use them. The goal is always the same: get to a real artifact fast enough that the conversation can move forward.

I'm based in Tokyo, working in an environment where navigating ambiguity - cultural, linguistic, contextual - is just part of the day. I'd welcome the chance to show you what I mean in practice.